Importance of food storage in a food service

- Preserve wholesomeness of the food.
- Protect quality of the food ingredients.
- Maintain expected shelf life of the product.
- Reduce wastage and spoilage.
- Control temperature.
- Prevent food contamination.
- Ensure safe for consumption.
- Stabilize the price.
- Future use.
- Cope with demand, production on a continuous basis.

In any type of food service operation, three different storages are essential.

Table 3.3 Types of Food Storage

S.No.	Type of storage	Foods to be stored	Temperature	Characteristics of storage place
1	Dry storage	Cereals, canned foods, flour, sugar, shortenings, spices, certain fruits and vegetables like bananas, onions and potatoes.	21°C	• Should be clean • Adequate ventilation with sufficient air circulation • Low humidity
2	Refrigerator storage	Fresh, cooked or partially cooked foods (milk, meat, vegetables)	0–7°C	• Regular cleaning of condenser coil should be done • Do not open the door frequently
3	Frozen storage	Meat, Ice cream, Butter, Cheese, Milk	–18°C	• Accumulation of ice should be cleared frequently • Proper air circulation is preferable.

Table 3.4 Ideal Ways of Storage

S.No.	Food ingredients	Storage
1	Cereals, pulses	Rigid sealed container or metal can
2	Fruits and other vegetables	Simple evaporative air cooled cabinets
3	Roots and tubers	Dry place for storage
4	Milk and milk products	Mechanical refrigerator
5	Egg	Egg cartons
6	Fish	Wooden or concrete acid resistant tanks
7	Meat	Hanging in carefully controlled environments
8	Fats and oils	Air tight container
9	Spices	Glass or plastic container
10	Canned foods	Cool and dry place
11	Frozen foods	Store at appropriate temperature after purchase.

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